

Chapter 27-2

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The magazine department was still in chaos.

When Liang Shi went out, it was lunch break time, but at 2:00 PM there would be afternoon clock-in to continue work.

Obviously, she was overtime.

When she went to the entrance to clock in, it already showed 35 minutes overtime.

The overtime electronic announcement broadcasted in the office area, and a group of people turned their heads to look in unison.

Somewhat embarrassing.

Liang Shi immediately returned to her workstation. The little girl from this morning was still sitting there reading.

After she came in the morning, everyone in the magazine department was very busy and had no time to pay attention to her.

It might also be that they simply didn't like this third-rate educated airborne soldier, so they treated her as invisible, wanting to give her a lesson.

Based on what they said in the restroom, the latter possibility was more likely.

Liang Shi didn't mind. She came here just to find a job. It would be good if she could learn something, and if not, she would do other things.

She wouldn't waste time anyway.

She still had a series of movies she had collected before that she hadn't watched, and there was also the entertainment industry ecosystem in this world that she hadn't understood yet.

Since no one assigned her work, she was quite content.

At three o'clock, the magazine department held a new round of topic selection meeting.

The editor-in-chief was still irritable, taking the new topics and cursing every department bloody.

"We have to meet with the general manager at five o'clock, and we must come up with satisfactory topics. But now, look at what you've submitted! Not a single one is usable! Your thinking is all rigid, isn't it?! Besides those traffic stars on Weibo, can't you come up with new topics? Our luxury goods aren't necessarily all for celebrities. Small-time celebrities can't even afford Dongheng's luxury goods! Do you have brains?!" The editor-in-chief's voice was extremely high and sharp.

Liang Shi stood in the back row. She had no idea what topics everyone had submitted, just mixing in to put on an act.

Unexpectedly, the editor-in-chief suddenly called her out, "Newcomer, tell us what you think about this topic selection."

Liang Shi: "...?"

She pointed at her nose in disbelief, "Me?"

The editor-in-chief nodded, "Yes, you."

Liang Shi was stunned for two seconds. Before she could speak, the editor-in-chief threw that stack of manuscripts on the table, "Don't know anything, what are you here for? To get paid for nothing?! I don't care whose connections got you in here. Since you're in the magazine department, you have to follow the magazine department's rules. Being late for more than half an hour on your first day of work - what kind of work attitude is that?"

"Sorry." Liang Shi indeed had no argument for this point, "I had something urgent today..."

"Did you ask for leave?" The editor-in-chief said, "Not asking for leave is called absenteeism. Three times and you can be directly fired. Moreover, you don't know anything, can't do anything - what are you doing in the magazine department? Do you think our magazine department is for collecting trash?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"Editor-in-chief." Liang Shi frowned, wanting to retort, when someone next to her suddenly tugged at her sleeve, signaling her to be quiet and not confront the editor-in-chief head-on.

But just these two words also made the editor-in-chief explode, "What? Think there's something wrong with what I said? If you don't want to stay in the magazine department, just switch departments, then you won't have to listen to my harsh words. Even if you're the group CEO's daughter, if you come to the magazine department and don't work properly, you still have to get lost!"

Liang Shi: "..."

Her patience had reached its limit.

She wasn't unfamiliar with workplace environments. When she was young and just entered society, she had experienced all kinds of harsh environments.

But they were all about high work intensity, or workplace seniors ganging up to give her a hard time, plus making her buy coffee and drinks, ordering her around to do odd jobs.

After becoming an adult, she changed jobs and learned to protect herself, and had never been called out like this and cursed bloody.

Obviously, this leader was just using work as an excuse to vent emotions.

She had always hated such people.

The colleague next to her was being kind, plus Liang Shi was on her first day, and her own behavior was indeed somewhat problematic.

Being anxious for a moment, not knowing who to ask for leave, she directly slipped out, thinking she could make it back before work time.

So she took a deep breath and endured it.

But unexpectedly, the editor-in-chief said: "I just asked you, what's your opinion on this magazine topic selection? Are you deaf? Can't you hear my question? If this is your work attitude, then get lost early. Our magazine department doesn't support deadweight."

Liang Shi: "..."

She stared tightly at the editor-in-chief, this woman in her early forties with slicked-back hair, thin lips, but very vicious speech.

"What? Not convinced?" The editor-in-chief sneered, "I thought you had some great ability, entering Dongheng with a pheasant diploma, and this is it? Someone who doesn't understand anything, what's wrong with me saying a few words to you? If you don't understand, then learn properly, instead of being absent on your first day."

"First." Liang Shi couldn't help but speak up. She was taller than everyone present, her gaze lightly sweeping over the crowd, her voice also very indifferent, yet naturally carrying the aura of someone in authority, "I apologize for leaving without asking for leave today. I just arrived and didn't have this awareness. It's my problem."

"Second, aside from that point, I don't think I have any problems. Regardless of my education, as long as I've entered Dongheng and this department, it necessarily means I have outstanding qualities. As a leader, shouldn't you be discovering the characteristics of new employees for your department's use? I can communicate in foreign languages, use PS, can also do interviews, including writing interview drafts and helping with photography. You haven't asked about any of these, directly denying me as a person based on my education - isn't that too short-sighted of you?"

Everyone exchanged glances privately, all trembling.

Everyone's eyes revealed one meaning - the newcomer is directly confronting the editor-in-chief like this?

Actually, everyone also felt the editor-in-chief was being somewhat reckless.

Such a newcomer, if airborne, must be a connections hire. Just arrange a workstation for her, assign some idle work, wouldn't that be fine?

Casually supporting her wouldn't be a big deal. Why make such a big fuss about scolding her, even specifically targeting her? This was very low-class.

Who knows when she might hit an iron plate.

However, those who knew the inside story could understand. This editor-in-chief's previous magazine company had an airborne new editor-in-chief who directly squeezed her into a deputy editor position, so after she jumped ship to Dongheng, she particularly hated connections hires and airborne soldiers.

Plus at such a critical moment, she had been agitated for several days already, just lacking an outlet.

The newcomer directly hit the gun muzzle.

Let's see who would win.

Footnotes:

1. 三流學歷 (**sān liú xué lì**) - "Third-rate education" - referring to a degree from a low-quality or poorly regarded university.
2. 空降兵 (**kōng jiàng bīng**) - Literally "paratrooper," but in corporate context refers to someone who is hired or promoted from outside the company into a high position, often implying they got the position through connections rather than merit.
3. 下馬威 (**xià mǎ wēi**) - "Show of strength" or "demonstration of power" - giving someone a harsh lesson or intimidating display on their first encounter.
4. 狗血淋頭 (**gǒu xuè lín tóu**) - Literally "dog blood pouring over the head," meaning to be severely scolded or criticized harshly.
5. 撞槍口 (**zhuàng qiāng kǒu**) - "Hit the gun muzzle" - to run into trouble at the worst possible time, like walking into a line of fire.